

Franklin

Operations Engineer - Onboarding Guide

9 Key Tasks Before Your Start

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July 2026

Welcome to Franklin

This guide outlines 9 concrete tasks we're working on. Each task includes the **what**, **why**, **concrete steps**, **success criteria**, and key **links** you'll need. No pressure - take it at your own pace.

1. Nudge Emails for Incomplete Onboarding (High Priority)

What

Automated email flow that sends reminders to new users stuck mid-onboarding.

Why

We lose people halfway through - they start but give up. If we nudge them after X days with a smart email, completion rates go way up.

Concrete Steps

- Postmark integration to send the emails
- Database query to find users in 'incomplete onboarding state'
- Scheduled job running daily/weekly
- Personalized template (their name, which steps they're missing)

Success Criteria

Email goes out, people come back and finish onboarding.

Resources

Postmark docs · Database schema for onboarding status

2. Postmark Email Template 'Month-End Close Reminder'

What

Concrete email templates that remind users when month-end closing is approaching.

Why

We use Postmark for templates, and we need this set up right so emails look professional and drive action.

Concrete Steps

- 2 versions of template (with and without dynamic data from our system)
- V1: Shows user's progress on transaction categorization, uploaded receipts, etc.
- V2: Generic version if we can't pull dynamic data
- Add emojis to make it less bleak
- CTA that links directly into their dashboard

Success Criteria

Template lives in Postmark and you can test send it.

Resources

Postmark template builder

3. Set Up Vercel (Staging + Prod)

What

Configure Vercel deployments for staging and production - so we can test features safely before going live.

Why

Critical to separate - testing shouldn't affect live users.

Concrete Steps

- Create 2 environments in Vercel (staging and prod)
- Configure environment variables for each
- Auto-deploy from Git branches (main → prod, dev → staging)
- Set up domain routing

Success Criteria

You can push to dev-branch and see it on staging domain; prod is isolated.

Resources

4. Biometric Notifications (NIUM Integration)

What

When a user completes biometric verification (NIUM), we need a notification so we know to trigger the next step.

Why

This is the trigger point where we need to start prepping their card integration. It's critical.

Concrete Steps

- NIUM webhook integration that fires when biometric is done
- Notification comes in (Slack? Email? Dashboard?)
- Trigger the next workflow (card creation, settlement setup, etc.)

Success Criteria

You complete biometric in test account, notification pops up within 30 seconds.

Resources

NIUM webhook docs · NIUM integration

5. Platform Banner System

What

Simple banner system to show service updates, errors, or important messages to all users.

Why

When something's down or we're doing maintenance, people need to know. Better than radio silence.

Concrete Steps

- Component that renders at the top of the app
- Admin interface where you can choose 'error', 'warning', 'info', etc.

- Auto-dismiss after X time or manual close
- Configured in database or env variable

Success Criteria

You go to admin panel, write 'We're doing maintenance right now' - it shows to all live users.

Resources

Retool admin setup · Design guidelines

6. Slack Notifications (Migration from Retool)

What

Move our Slack notifications out of Retool and build them directly - so they're instant and reliable.

Why

Retool is slow and flaky for critical alerts. We need to know immediately when something happens (failed payout, risk alert, etc.).

Concrete Steps

- Database triggers or workflow to monitor events
- Direct Slack webhook integration
- Message templates for different event types
- Retry logic if Slack is down

Success Criteria

When something critical happens, Slack notification arrives within 10 seconds.

Resources

Slack Webhook API · Event logger

7. PLUNK Setup (Email Marketing & Nudges)

What

PLUNK is an email marketing/automation service we'll use for campaigns, nudges, etc.

Why

We need to send targeted campaigns without building everything custom.

Concrete Steps

- PLUNK account setup
- Segment users based on behavior (e.g. 'has card', 'haven't completed onboarding', etc.)
- Automation flows (welcome series, dormant user nudges, etc.)
- Template library

Success Criteria

You can log into PLUNK and see all our segments, send a test email to yourself.

Resources

PLUNK docs · Segmentation strategy

8. RFI (Request For Information) Automate Support Responses

What

When RFIs or requests for information come in (regulatory, partner checks, etc.), they should auto-route and be handled.

Why

They come via email/portal and it's manual overhead. We need templated responses and auto-categorization.

Concrete Steps

- Support platform integration
- Rules to route requests to the right person
- Auto-response templates based on RFI type
- Track completion status

Success Criteria

RFI comes in, system categorizes it, relevant person gets notified, templated response can be sent.

Resources

Support platform docs · RFI templates

9. Letter of Authorization (Power of Attorney) - Full Automation

What

Automated workflow for 'power of attorney' documents. Users sign a document, it becomes a PDF, gets sent to Penneo for e-signature, and auto-uploads to NIUM when signed.

Why

Huge friction point. People need to sign off on things to get their card activated. If we can automate this, we shave weeks off their setup time.

Concrete Steps

- Database query: pull user details and company info
- Document generator (template in system, populate with data, render as PDF)
- Penneo integration: upload unsigned PDF, get signing flow link
- Webhook from Penneo: when doc is signed, download it
- Upload to NIUM: the final piece
- Tracking: status in user's dashboard

Success Criteria

User triggers 'sign power of attorney', they get email link, sign in Penneo, it's automatically on NIUM 30 seconds after.

Resources

Penneo API docs · NIUM integration · PDF generator library

Tips for Getting Started

- Spike any tasks you're unsure about first, so we can align when you start
- If something looks unclear, write a spike doc (5 mins to read, 30 mins research max)
- We've gotten a lot of the infra in order over the past few months, so much of this exists partially - you're mainly connecting pieces

Questions?

No pressure on any of this. We're excited to have you on board and we'll have plenty of time to align when you start. Feel free to reach out if anything is unclear.